

2026 Political Advertising Forecast

August 2026 update · first issued April 2026

\$10.4B

Projected 2026 political advertising spending across broadcast, cable, radio, and streaming & digital — all 210 U.S. media markets.

\$1.2B

FORWARD RESERVATIONS ALREADY ON FILE

1.5M

AD OCCURRENCES MONITORED PER DAY

303

RACES WITH POSTED OR DETECTED MONEY

40M

HOUSEHOLDS MEASURING STREAMING ON THE GLASS

HOW THIS NUMBER IS BUILT

The forecast rides the same dataset as the KPI platform: posted station orders and public FCC filings priced at real costs, radio orders joined to television's race and advertiser records, and streaming detected where it runs — on the TV screen, in 40 million measured households, weighted to census. Modeled shares print as estimates, dated, and are never blended into posted totals.

The August update revises the April 2026 issue on posted orders and forward reservations through August 30, 2026. Race-level and market-level detail runs in the full report and on the platform, where every read exports with its through-date.